A REPORT ON

Analyzing and Classifying Fake News on Twitter

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23STUCHH010820

Project Report submitted to Icfai Tech as a partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the Degree of B.Tech in cse under the supervision of MR. SRINIVASU BADUGU direction.



Faculty of Science & Technology, IFHE University,
APRIL 2026

CERTIFCATE

This is to certify that the special Project entitled "Personalized Recommendation System with Artificial Intelligence" submitted by VARUN TEJ KALLAGANTI, bearing Roll Number [23STUCHH010820], in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of the degree of Computer Science Engineering is a record of the original work carried out by him under my guidance. The project has not been submitted elsewhere for the award of any other degree or diploma.

Signature of the student

Date: _____

Signature of the Guide

Date: _____

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I would like to express my sincere gratitude to all those who helped me throughout this Capstone Project.First and foremost, I extend my heartfelt thanks to all my mentors for their constant support, guidance, and insightful feedback. Their expertise was instrumental in shaping my understanding and execution of the project.

I am especially grateful to thank my university guide, MR. SRINIVASU BADUGU, for her encouragement and academic direction. The knowledge and experience gained during this internship will be immensely beneficial for my academic and professional growth.

I am also thankful to the Head of the Department, Mrs. Rohini, and all the faculty members of Computer **Science** for providing the necessary resources and a conducive environment for the project.

I am also grateful to the ICFAI Tech for providing me with this invaluable opportunity to learn, explore, and implement the concepts practically.

Finally, I would like to thank my family and friends for their continuous support and understanding.

Signature of the student

VARUN TEJ KALLAGANTI

DECLARATION

I declare that the work contained in the Project Report is original and it has been done by me under the supervision of MR. SRINIVASU BADUGU. The work has not been submitted to any other University for the award of any degree or diploma.

Date: April , 2026

Abstract

The rapid growth of social media platforms has significantly increased the spread of misinformation, making fake news detection a critical challenge. Twitter, being one of the most widely used platforms for real-time information sharing, is particularly vulnerable to the انتشار of misleading and false content. This project focuses on developing an automated fake news detection system using machine learning and Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques. The system analyzes tweet content, linguistic patterns, and user behavior to classify information as real or fake. Text preprocessing methods such as tokenization, stop-word removal, and stemming are applied to clean the data, followed by feature extraction techniques like TF-IDF. Various classification algorithms, including Logistic Regression, Naïve Bayes, and Support Vector Machines, are used to improve prediction accuracy. The model is trained and tested on labeled Twitter datasets. The results demonstrate that the system can effectively identify fake tweets, helping to reduce the spread of misinformation and improve the reliability of online information.

Keywords:
Fake News Detection, Twitter, Natural Language Processing (NLP), Machine Learning, Text Classification, TF-IDF, Logistic Regression, Naïve Bayes, Support Vector Machine (SVM), Social Media Analysis.

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Signature of Faculty
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Introduction

In recent years, social media platforms like Twitter have become primary sources of news and information for millions of users worldwide. While these platforms facilitate rapid information sharing, they also create an environment where fake news and misinformation can spread easily and quickly. The open nature of Twitter, where anyone can post content without verification, makes it highly susceptible to the dissemination of false information.Fake news refers to misleading or fabricated content presented as real news with the intention to deceive readers. The widespread circulation of such information can lead to serious consequences, including public panic, damage to reputation, and even manipulation of political events. Therefore, developing reliable systems to detect fake news on Twitter has become an important area of research in the field of Natural Language Processing (NLP) and Machine Learning (ML).Detecting fake news on Twitter presents several challenges. Tweets are typically short, contain slang, abbreviations, and hashtags, and often lack context. Additionally, fake news may not always be evident from the content of the tweet alone — it may require analyzing user behavior, the credibility of the source, and the propagation patterns of the news.This project aims to build an automated fake news detection system for Twitter using machine learning techniques. The proposed system will collect tweets, processor the text, extract relevant features, and classify the tweets as fake or real. Various machine learning and deep learning models such as Logistic Regression, Random Forest, LSTM, and BERT can be employed for this purpose.Moreover, the system can be enhanced by incorporating features such as sentiment analysis, user profile analysis, and social network-based features to improve detection accuracy. The performance of the models will be evaluated using standard metrics like accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score.This project focuses on developing a fake news detection system using Natural Language Processing (NLP) and machine learning techniques. The system analyzes textual content of tweets by applying preprocessing methods such as tokenization, stop-word removal, and stemming. Feature extraction techniques like TF-IDF are used to convert text into numerical representations. Classification algorithms such as Logistic Regression, Naïve Bayes, and Support Vector Machine (SVM) are then applied to classify tweets as real or fake.The proposed system aims to improve the accuracy and efficiency of fake news detection while reducing the spread of misinformation on social media platforms. By providing reliable classification of tweets, the system contributes to creating a more trustworthy digital environment.

LITERATURE REVIEW

Social media is nowadays one of the main news sources for millions of people around the globe due to their low cost, easy access, and rapid dissemination. This however comes at the cost of dubious trustworthiness and significant risk of exposure to ‘fake news’, intentionally written to mislead the readers. Automatically detecting fake news poses challenges that defy existing content-based analysis approaches. One of the main reasons is that often the interpretation of the news requires the knowledge of political or social context or ‘common sense’, which current natural language processing algorithms are still missing. Recent studies have empirically shown that fake and real news spread differently on social media, forming propagation patterns that could be harnessed for the automatic fake news detection. Propagation-based approaches have multiple advantages compared to their content-based counterparts, among which is language independence and better resilience to adversarial attacks. In this paper, we show a novel automatic fake news detection model based on geometric deep learning. The underlying core algorithms are a generalization of classical convectional neural networks to graphs, allowing the fusion of heterogeneous data such as content, user profile and activity, social graph, and news propagation. Our model was trained and tested on news stories, verified by professional fact-checking organizations, that were spread on Twitter. Our experiments indicate that social network structure and propagation are important features allowing highly accurate (92.7% ROC AUC) fake news detection. Second, we observe that fake news can be reliably detected at an early stage, after just a few hours of propagation. Third, we test the aging of our model on training and testing data separated in time. Our results point to the promise of propagation-based approaches for fake news detection as an alternative or complementary strategy to content-based approaches.

- Various studies highlight the use of **machine learning and NLP techniques** for detecting fake news on social media platforms like Twitter
- **Collaborative approaches** using data mining and feature extraction help in analyzing user behavior and content patterns
- Advanced models like **BERT and deep learning techniques** improve accuracy by understanding contextual relationships in text
- Systems such as **FakeNewsTracker** provide end-to-end solutions including data collection, detection, and visualization
- Individual methods have limitations, so **hybrid approaches combining multiple techniques** are more effective for accurate fake news detection

METHODOLOGY

1. Data Collection

Collect labeled tweet data (real and fake) from sources like Kaggle

Ensure dataset contains relevant features such as tweet text and labels

2. Data Preprocessing

Clean text by removing URLs, punctuation, and special characters

Apply tokenization, stop-word removal, and stemming

3. Text Normalization

Convert all text to lowercase for consistency

Standardize words to their base form using stemming/lemmatization

4. Feature Extraction (TF-IDF)

Convert textual data into numerical vectors using TF-IDF

Assign importance to words based on frequency and relevance

5. Dataset Splitting

Divide dataset into training and testing sets (e.g., 80:20)

Ensure balanced distribution of real and fake tweets

6. Model Selection

Choose suitable machine learning algorithm (Logistic Regression)

Consider efficiency and accuracy for text classification

7. Model Training

Train the model using the training dataset

Learn patterns between input features and output labels

8. Model Testing

Test the model using unseen data

Compare predicted results with actual labels

9. Performance Evaluation

Evaluate using accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score

Use confusion matrix to analyze errors

10. System Deployment

Deploy the model as a web application using Flask

Allow users to input tweets and get real-time predictions

CONCLUSION

In this project, a fake news detection system for Twitter has been successfully designed and implemented using machine learning and Natural Language Processing (NLP) techniques. The system effectively addresses the growing challenge of misinformation on social media platforms by automatically classifying tweets as real or fake. With the rapid increase in online content, manual verification of information has become impractical, making automated solutions essential.The project involved multiple stages, including data collection, preprocessing, feature extraction using TF-IDF, model building, and performance evaluation. Logistic Regression was implemented as the primary classification algorithm due to its simplicity and effectiveness in handling text-based data. The preprocessing techniques helped in cleaning noisy tweet data, while TF-IDF ensured meaningful feature representation.The performance of the system was evaluated using standard metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score. The results demonstrate that the model is capable of identifying fake tweets with a reasonable level of accuracy. Additionally, the system was designed to be scalable and adaptable, allowing it to handle large datasets and real-time inputs.Overall, this project highlights the importance of AI-driven solutions in combating the spread of fake news. By providing an efficient and reliable detection system, it contributes to improving the credibility of information shared on social media. Future enhancements can further improve accuracy by incorporating deep learning models and real-time data integration.

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